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Editorial Submission Process and Peer Review

Teaching Team of Ethics and Scientific Writing Technique Course

Faculty of Engineering
Universitas Gadjah Mada, 2025

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Contents

- ❑ Selecting your outlet for publication
- ❑ Preparing a cover letter
- ❑ Response to Review

1

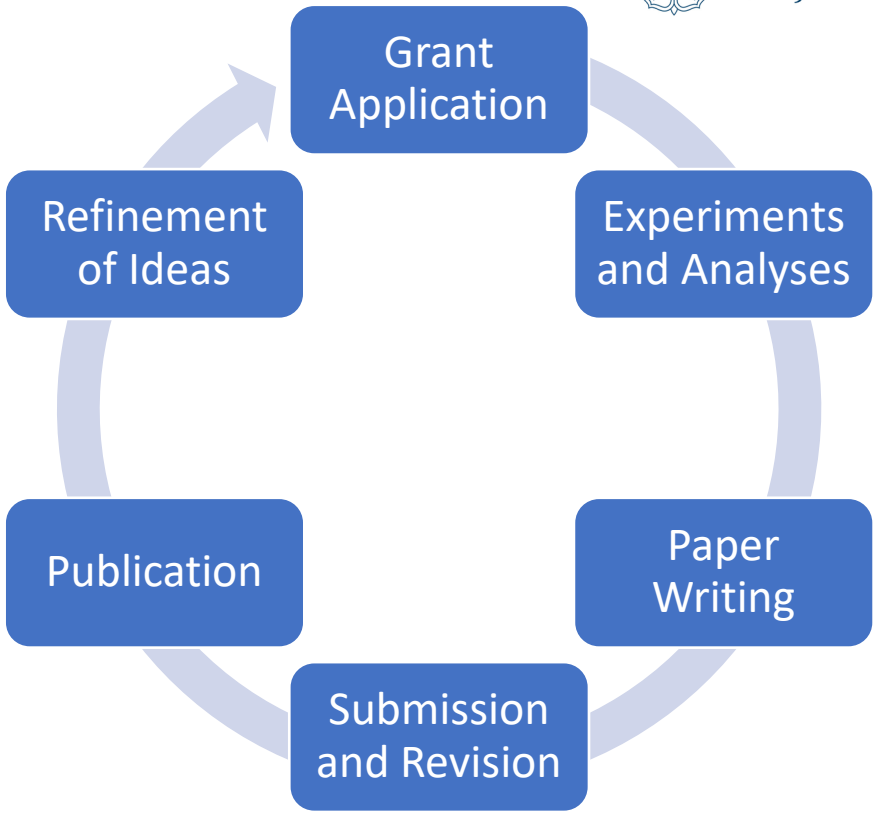
Selecting Your Outlet for Publication

What makes a great Paper ?

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Great Research!

- ❑ Strong evidence
- ❑ noteworthy conclusions
- ❑ a compelling story: effective, clear writing and know your audience



Great research arises prospectively

- ❑ Exciting findings usually result from asking a good question.
- ❑ Thoughtful experimental design, taking into account any need for statistical analysis from the start.
- ❑ Well chosen, and well executed protocols.

Before submission

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- There is no secret formula or back door that guarantees publication in a top journal; editors apply the same criteria to every submission.
- The research question, data and findings are the key factors.
- Take a step back from the work when assessing your findings and selecting a journal.
- Briefly and objectively explain the importance of your findings.
- Don’t lose sight of the fact that studies can be extremely influential and high quality even if they are not published in a journal such as Nature.



Selection of Publication Outlet

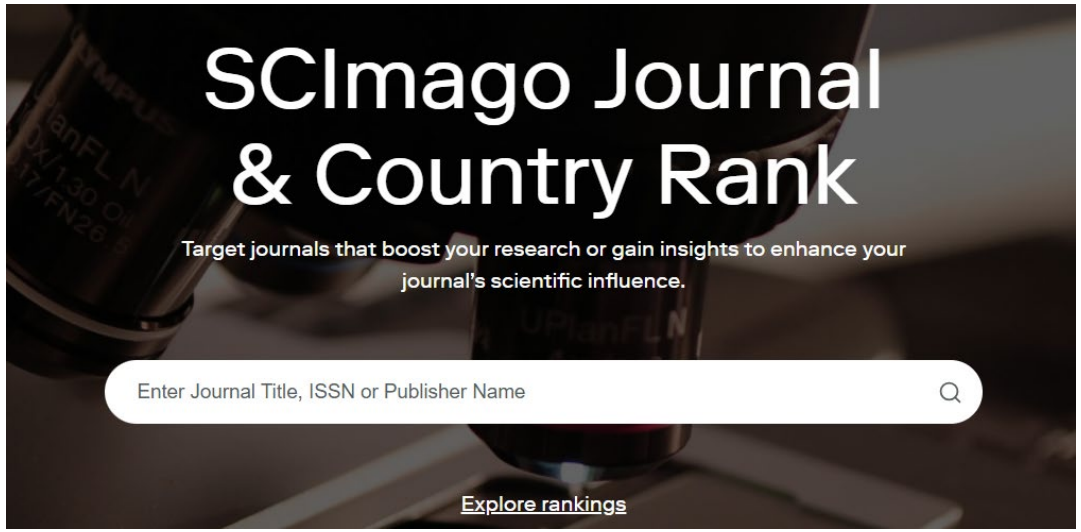
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- **Audience**: understand who you want to reach. Consider the readership of different journals or platform and how they align with your audience.
- **Scope and focus**: Choose an outlet that fits the topic and scope of your research. Typically, the best way to select journal is based on what you have read (you write in the same place as your references) to ensure the scope is well covered by the journal.
- **Impact factor and reputation**: look at the journal's reputation, impact factor and their review process (realistic publication turnaround times: too fast acceptance decision is not good (indicate not serious review process and only aim for money), too long process is also bad (it indicates that they don't respect the manuscript we submit)).
- **Open access vs subscription**: check if your target journals have Article Processing Charge (APC). Currently it becomes a major issue and you can decide to make it open or closed (for subscription only). More and more journals only provide open access document with high price of APC. Diamond Open Access refers to a scholarly publication model in which journals and platforms do not charge fees to either authors or readers (very few).

Selection of Publication Outlet

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The first place to check your choice and journal reputation is usually: SCIMAGO (scimagojr.com)



Reputable journals should at least appear in SCIMAGO

Example:

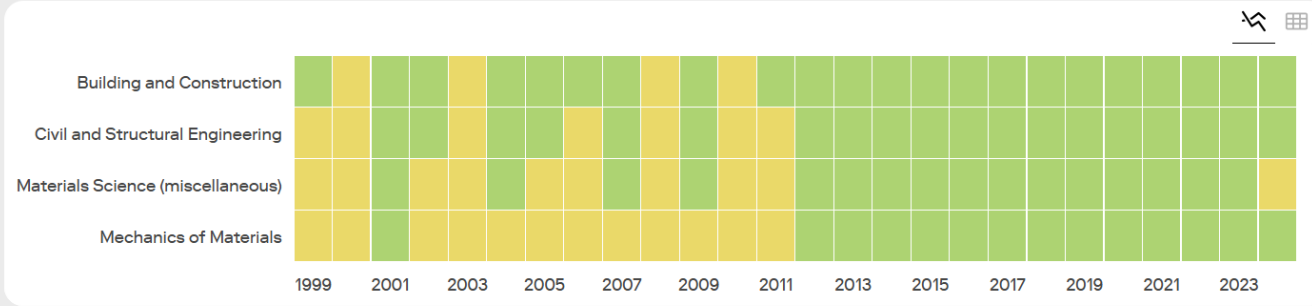
Journal of Materials in Civil Engineering

United States | Universities and research institutions | Media Ranking

Scope

The Journal of Materials in Civil Engineering covers the development, processing, evaluation, applications, and performance of construction materials in civil engineering.

Quartiles

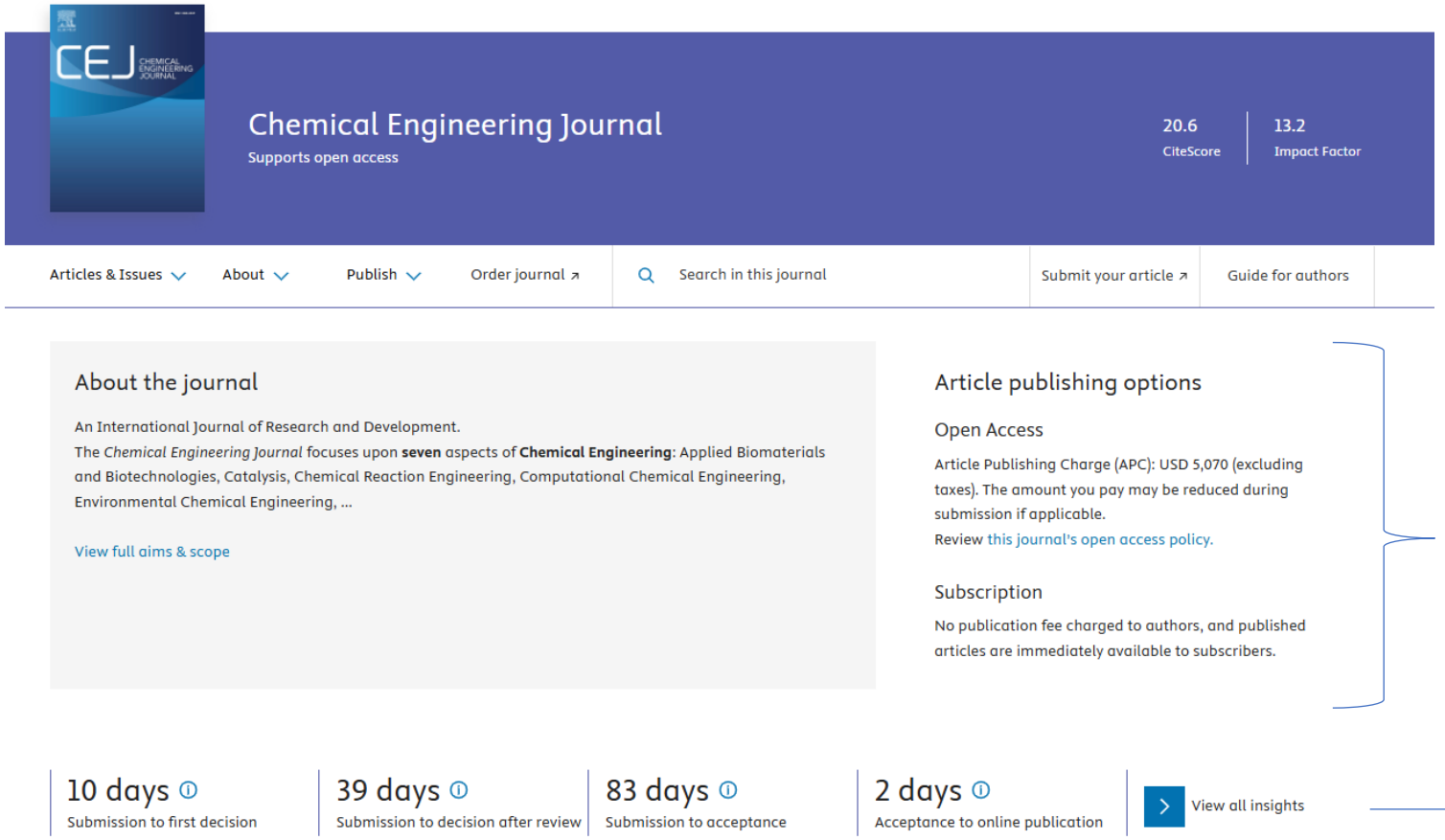


https://www.scimagojr.com/journalsearch.php?q=16299&tip=sid&clean=0

Article Processing Charge (APC)

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In general, we can see the article publishing option in Journal website:



For this example:

They offer 2 types of publication options, the one with APC and without APC (Subscription)

Information about processing time

Be careful, there are many predator journals out there which only aims to take your money by promising fast processing time and guarantee acceptance without proper peer review process.

2

Preparing a cover letter

Cover letters

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- ❑ An opportunity to address the editor directly
- ❑ Comment on why your research is suitable for that journal specifically
- ❑ Show that you care to your manuscript!



Unhelpful Cover letters

November 26, 2002

Editor
Nature Genetics
345 Park Avenue South, 10th Floor
New York, NY 10010-1707
USA

Dear Editor,

It is not clear why a cover letter is required except to fulfill the silly British preoccupation with letterhead and other emblems of status.

Please accept my correspondence.

Sincerely,

Cover letter

Dear Editor,
We would like to submit our manuscript entitled [title] as a [format] in [journal name].

[to our knowledge, this is the first report showing….This is important because…]

We believe our findings would appeal to the readership of [journal name]….

Possible referees we would suggest….

We look forward to hearing from you at your earliest convenience….

The basics:
Title of the paper, format (e.g. article/letter)

The pitch:
- Very brief context of direct relevance to your findings
- Key finding (related to context)
- Why is it important?
- Interest to that journal's readers.

Other requirements:
- Referees for in/exclusion
- Author and affilizations
- Contact information

Example Cover letter

Dr Peter Gorsuch
Super Editor
Neuropathology Today

My address

April 2nd 2012

Dear Dr. Gorsuch,

We are delighted to offer our paper entitled "The small molecule X alleviates non-motor symptoms of early-onset Parkinson's disease" for publication in *Neuropathology Today*.

Parkinson's disease affects # people worldwide, with an associated cost of $#m in the USA alone. Dopamine replacement strategies have provided the first steps towards improving the motor symptoms typically associated with the disease, but much progress remains to be made for non-motor symptoms such as…, which are important because…. In contrast, there is currently no effective treatment for non-motor symptoms. A Review by Blah et al. recently identified this as a key research priority.

In this paper, we demonstrate that the novel peptide X relieves non-motor symptoms of early-onset Parkinson's disease in… mice, in a laboratory setting. Specifically, by interfering with…, … Building on this promising finding, we then describe a preliminary clinical study of 32 human sufferers of early-onset Parkinson's, in which… Intriguingly, the therapy had no effect on late-onset Parkinson's suggesting that…

← Submission details

← Background/context

← Objectives/findings

Example Cover letter

We believe that peptide X has enormous potential as a... Furthermore, our finding that late-onset... implies that... [which has a further important implication]. Although we feel that our findings are of wide interest, in this case we have chosen the relatively specialised *Neuropathology Today* because we wish to... and we value...

As possible referees we would like to suggest:

1. Joe Bloggs, University of Disneyland, who is a leader in the method that we employ. J.Bloggs@disneylandflorida.edu
2. Ref 2

We confirm that this manuscript is not under consideration by any other journal, and we have no conflict of interest to declare.

We look forward to hearing from you at your earliest convenience.

Yours sincerely,
Dr. Flora-Beth Flaubert, on behalf of all authors.

Reference:
...

Relevance

Referees

Statements
(It is important to state that you do not conduct double submission to other journal) → strongly prohibitive

Corresponding author contact details

Example Cover letter

COVER LETTER

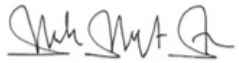
Dear Sir/Madam,

In this opportunity, we would like to submit a manuscript entitled "Kinetic Study on The Slow Pyrolysis of Isolated Cellulose and Lignin from Teak Sawdust" to Thermochimica Acta Journal. In this paper, we present explored many alternatives to model the pyrolysis of teak sawdust by using multi-component n^{th}-order Distributed Activation Energy Model (DAEM). Additionally, a model-free kinetic analyses were also utilized to add more insight and to the kinetics study. We expect that this study may provide better understanding on the kinetics of biomass pyrolysis.

All authors of this work have agreed to submit the manuscript to Thermochimica Acta Journal and have not submitted this manuscript elsewhere. We believe this manuscript is appropriate for publication in Thermochimica Acta Journal, as the topic of this work appertains the Reaction Kinetics and Mechanisms scope of the Thermochimica Acta Journal.

In the end, we would like to thank your time, response, and considerations for our work.

Sincerely Yours,

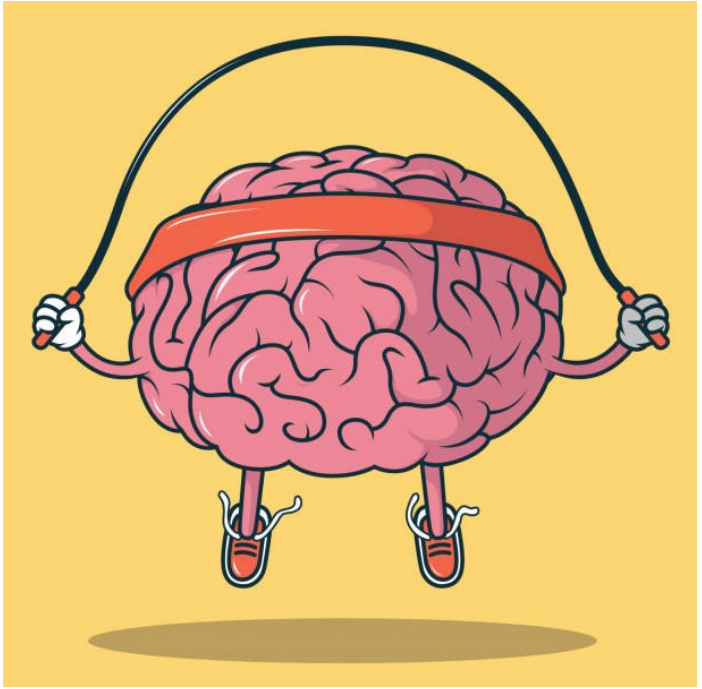


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e-mail : muhammad.azis@ugm.ac.id

- Usually, you should provide Suggested Reviewers of your field that you can search in Google.
- If the manuscript has ever been submitted to other journal and rejected, if necessary, you can mention it than show your improvements.
- Many academic seniors have been involved as a reviewer or referee for numerous reputable journals. Don't simply use AI to prepare your cover letter or to review a manuscript. Show your genuine idea to tackle a real research problem.

Submit your paper

- After you prepare a cover letter, you need to combine all of your manuscript and submit it through the journal website, accordingly.
- Follow carefully step by step of your submission.
- Once you finish your submission, wish the best that you get the best result from your submission.
- You need to prepare your "*mental strength*" to receive any decision from the Editor. It can be stressful if journal publication is an important requirement to partially fulfill your degree.



www.istockphoto.com

Receiving decision : decline your submission

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Ms. Ref. No.: APCATB-D-12-00361
Title: Microkinetic modeling of H2-assisted NO oxidation over Ag-Al2O3.
Applied Catalysis B: Environmental

Dear Mr. ABC,

Your manuscript, entitled "Microkinetic modeling of H2-assisted NO oxidation over Ag-Al2O3.", which was submitted for publication in Applied Catalysis B, has been reviewed by two of your peers.

The reviewers point out certain deficiencies and do not recommend publication of this manuscript.

I am sorry that under the present situation **I would have to decline your manuscript from publication in Applied Catalysis B**. For your guidance, I append the reviewers' comments below.

Thank you for giving us the opportunity to consider your work.

Yours sincerely,

XYZ, Professor
Editor
Applied Catalysis B: Environmental



https://wallpapers.com/images/featured-full/sad-cartoon-3zi43wc9v0gaf7v2.jpg

Take your time, Recharge, and Come Back Stronger

Receiving decision : accept your submission

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Ms. Ref. No.: CEJ-D-12-03865R1
Title: Microkinetic modeling of H2-assisted NO oxidation over Ag-Al2O3
Chemical Engineering Journal

Dear Dr. ABC,

I am pleased to confirm that your paper "Microkinetic modeling of H2-assisted NO oxidation over Ag-Al2O3" has been accepted for publication in Chemical Engineering Journal.

You are invited to submit either a figure from your article or other illustration that is representative of your manuscript for possible inclusion on the journal cover. If you wish for your figure or illustration to be considered, please carefully follow the instructions in the Guide for Authors at the link below. Please note that we must receive your submission within 10 days of the date of this letter and that this is a competitive process with only one figure selected out of the many submitted for each issue. Due to the number of submissions, you will only receive further correspondence if your image has been selected.

See "Submissions of figures for cover" at:
http://www.elsevier.com/wps/find/journaldescription.cws_home/601273/authorinstructions#57200.

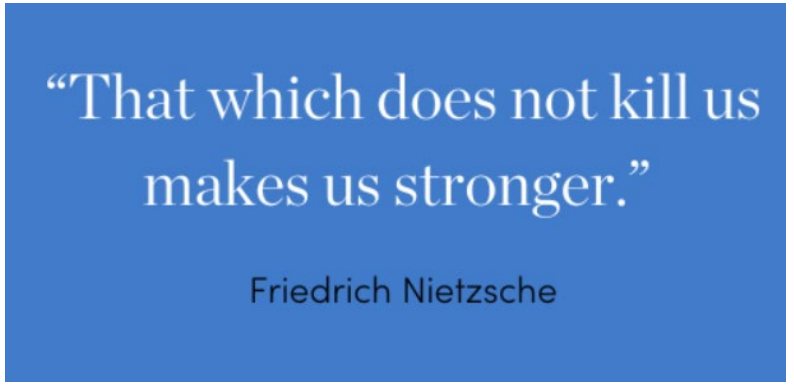
Participation is optional and no action is required if you do not wish to submit an image for the cover.

Thank you for submitting your work to this journal.

With kind regards,
Professor XYZ
Editor
Chemical Engineering Journal



Shutterstock.com



https://www.success.com/21-motivational-quotes-about-strength/

3

Response to Review

Response to reviewer

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- ❑ After certain weeks of submission, usually we will receive first round of editor decision. If it is not rejected, then we have the opportunity to revise our manuscript (it is common to receive major revisions).
- ❑ Typically you will receive comments from 2-3 reviewers. You have about 1 month to revise your manuscript.
- ❑ You should answer each comments carefully in diplomatic way. Don't show your emotions ☺
- ❑ Some comments usually can be very tough but you have the time to deal with it.
- ❑ Reviewers comments are usually provided in a separate simple words document.
- ❑ Revision process can take just 1 round or as high as 3 rounds.

Example of Reviewer Comments

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Reviewer #2: After the review process, the quality of the manuscript is higher. However, there are still a couple of points that should be considered before publication:

1.- The novelty of the work should be clearly stated in the introduction section. A brief summary of the discussion of the authors on the novelty used in the response to the reviewers' comments could be included in the manuscript.

….

- - - -

Answering Reviewer Comments

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There are 2 methods to answer reviewer comments, in can be written in a narrative way or it can be presented in tabulated format. It is more common to provide your answers in a table format.

Example:

Response to Reviewer

Reviewer #1: I would like to thank the author for tackling this important issue and presenting the results in a clear way. The analysis is sound and the manuscript is clearly well written. Overall, I recommend that the editor publish this manuscript with only the minor revisions listed below:

Thank you for your feedback and appreciation on our manuscript. We have addressed your comments and made substantial efforts to revise the manuscript. Our responses and changes in manuscript are explained below.

No.	Comments	Response	Changes
1.	It would be better to spell out what the GWP, LU and CED stand for in the abstract, as some readers may not be familiar with these terminologies.	We agree with the reviewer and have added the full form of all abbreviations in the abstract.	At the baseline scenario, environmental impacts per ton cement are 647.35 kg CO_2 eq. of Global Warming Potential (GWP), 90.25 kg C deficit of Land Use (LU), and 4,707.24 MJ of Cumulative Energy Demand (CED)
2.	In Figure 4, I find it a bit odd to see both cement and concrete in this form, as cement is the raw material of concrete.	Thanks for your comment. It is true that cement is the raw material of concrete. What we display in Figure 4 is the amount of cement materials within the produced concrete in the in-use building material stocks in Cirebon Regency, West Java. To make our intention clearer for the reader, we added an additional sentence in Figure 4's caption, explaining the meaning of the displayed cement amount in the Figure.	We added an additional sentence in Figure 4's caption: 'The displayed cement amount is the total cement materials within the concrete in the in-use building material stocks in Cirebon Regency.'

“Writing in science is not only about reporting facts,
but about building understanding”

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LOCALLY ROOTED, GLOBALLY RESPECTED

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